

One of the most flamboyant features of Windows 8 is its new start screen. Windows, as we've known it since the past 15 years, has undergone radical change and the desktop is no more the same. Mobiles have invaded our computing experience and Windows 8 duly reflects that trend.

Getting to the desktop

You log on to Windows and the desktop is there waiting for you. Windows 8 changes that a bit. In the new iteration of Windows, you don't have a desktop anymore. When you switch your system on, the first thing you see is a start screen with live application tiles. These tiles keep updating information on their faces. No longer are any manual updates required for your email, weather and news. If it's new, it would be on the start screen. When you first see it, we're sure you'd be mesmerized by the beautiful show of colors while your intellect questions where the desktop went. Look closely and you'll



To reach the start screen, hover on the bottom left corner and click the box

surely locate your desktop as one of the tiles on the start screen though. Click it and you'd feel right at home! For keyboard lovers, the good old [Win] + [D] key combination also gets the job done.

While you're on the desktop, the one thing you're going to miss for sure is the start menu button. It's simply not there. Hover your cursor in that area and a rectangular box shows up with what looks like a snapshot of your start

screen. Clicking the box will take you to the start screen. In a very similar fashion, if you're working with a Modern UI app, hovering your mouse near the top-left corner of the screen would provide you with a snapshot of the desktop. Click it and you'd be taken back to it via a very nifty screen-flip animation.

Modern UI vs. Desktop apps

Frankly, this is the biggest dilemma with Windows 8. For the files most commonly used, Windows 8 provides you with more than one option. A fresh installation of Windows 8 sets the Photos app as the default application for